

MUNA ADEN

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EDUCATION

St. Cloud State University

St. Cloud, MN | Aug 2022 – May 2026

B.S. Cybersecurity | Honors Program | Dean's List, 4 Consecutive Years

Double Minor: Political Science & International Relations

Relevant Coursework: Ethical Hacking, IT Security & Risk Management, Advanced Scripting for Unix/Windows, Security Fundamentals & Laws, Cloud Computing, Computer Networks, Cybersecurity Capstone

EXPERIENCE

Splunk SIEM Operator – 1st Place State Champions

Jan 2026

Collegiate Cyber Defense Competition (CCDC) | Alexandria, MN

- Deployed 59 detection alerts in under 2 minutes by engineering `deploy_alerts.py` via the Splunk REST API, enabling immediate defensive coverage under live adversarial conditions
- Detected and escalated red team persistence mechanisms through continuous SIEM monitoring across endpoints and network systems, contributing directly to incident containment and recovery
- Operated as the sole SIEM analyst throughout the competition, triaging real-time alerts and driving a 1st place state championship finish — competed at NCCDC Regionals

Digital Forensics Intern

Jul 2025 – Aug 2025

Digital Forensics Now | Miami, FL

- Produced legally admissible investigation documentation by conducting forensic disk image analysis using Autopsy to identify malicious artifacts and reconstruct attack timelines, directly supporting active cases
- Detected suspicious network behavior and documented evidence for incident response by performing packet capture analysis with Wireshark, resulting in actionable findings for remediation and compliance reporting

PROJECTS

Splunk SIEM Homelab — Detection Engineering & SOC Automation | <https://github.com/muna-adan/Splunk-Siem-Homelab>

- Engineered 7 MITRE ATT&CK-mapped detection rules across Credential Access, Persistence, Lateral Movement, and Defense Evasion tactics, detecting live attacks simulated from Kali Linux in real time
- Cut manual triage time to zero by writing `auto_triage.py` — a Python tool that polls Splunk every 60 seconds, enriches attacker IPs via AbuseIPDB threat intelligence, scores risk, and logs structured case files automatically
- Developed `auto_triage.py` a SOAR-lite automation tool that polls Splunk every 60 seconds, enriches source IPs with AbuseIPDB threat intelligence, calculates a risk score, and logs structured case files automatically
- Built 2 Dashboard Studio dashboards: SOC Overview and MITRE ATT&CK Coverage, demonstrating full end-to-end detection engineering and SOC analyst workflow

AWS Cloud Security Audit, Senior Capstone

- Reduced privileged access risk across a multi-service AWS environment by designing 5 least-privilege IAM policies with MFA enforcement across EC2, S3, and RDS, removing overprivileged accounts as an attack vector
- Wrote a 6-file Terraform IaC module enabling repeatable, auditable infrastructure deployment and produced CIS AWS Foundations Benchmark compliance documentation across CloudTrail, CloudWatch, and GuardDuty
- Led a 5-person audit team and delivered a before-and-after security posture comparison, presented at the Engineering and Technology Expo

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

Certifications: CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701, Active) · TestOut Ethical Hacker Pro · Cisco Junior Cybersecurity Analyst · AWS Generative AI – Udacity · Cisco Security & Connectivity Support

Security Operations: Splunk SIEM · Log Analysis · Alert Triage · Incident Detection & Response · Threat Hunting · SOC Operations · MITRE ATT&CK

Cloud & IAM: AWS IAM · EC2 · S3 · RDS · CloudTrail · GuardDuty · Terraform IaC · CIS Benchmarks · Least Privilege · MFA Enforcement

Risk & Governance: NIST CSF/RMF · HIPAA · Risk Assessment & Scoring · Business Impact Analysis · Security Policy Writing · Third-Party Risk

Tools & Languages: Python · PowerShell · Bash · Ansible · Nessus · Nmap · Wireshark · Autopsy · Kali Linux · Linux · Windows · Virtualized Infrastructure